EXPERIMENT 15

Career Pathways and Future of Low-Code Development

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Subject: Low Code Application Development using Zoho Creator
Project: Bank Loan Application & Pre-Screening Management

Aim

To study career pathways in low-code development, the skills each role needs, and the future of low-code platforms such as Zoho Creator, with reference to the Bank Loan Application built in this lab series.

Introduction

Low-code development has created roles that sit between business analysis and software engineering. A person who can model data, design forms, write short scripts, connect services and apply governance is useful in almost any organisation that runs on internal applications. The Loan Application built in these experiments exercises that whole set of skills.

Career Pathways

Table 15.1: Roles in the low-code field

Role	What the person does	Core skills
Low-code developer	Builds applications on a platform such as Zoho Creator	Data modelling, forms, reports, workflows, Deluge
Business / functional analyst	Turns business needs into application designs	Requirements, process mapping, testing
Integration specialist	Connects the platform to other systems	APIs, connections, JSON, authentication
Solution architect	Chooses the right mix of low-code and pro-code	Architecture, security, scalability, governance
Platform administrator	Manages users, environments and releases	Roles, security, deployment, monitoring
Citizen developer	Builds small tools for their own team	Platform basics and good practice

Skills Demonstrated in this Lab Series

Table 15.2: Skills built through the experiments

Experiment	Skill
1 Report types	Presenting data for different users
2 Platform set-up	Navigating the platform and its architecture
3 Survey	Researching technology trends
4 Basic fields	Form design and validation
5 Advanced fields	Lookups, subforms, file fields, generated values
6 Workflows	Automation and Deluge scripting; testing and debugging
7 Integration	Connections and API calls
8 RBAC	Roles, permissions and data sharing
9 Page builder	Composing workspaces from elements
10 Performance	Efficient scripts and queries
11 Deployment	Environments and release control
12 Security	Security and governance practice
13 Limitations	Judging when low-code is not enough
14 Pro-code extension	Custom functions and external services
15 Career pathways	Planning a path in the field

Suggested Learning Path

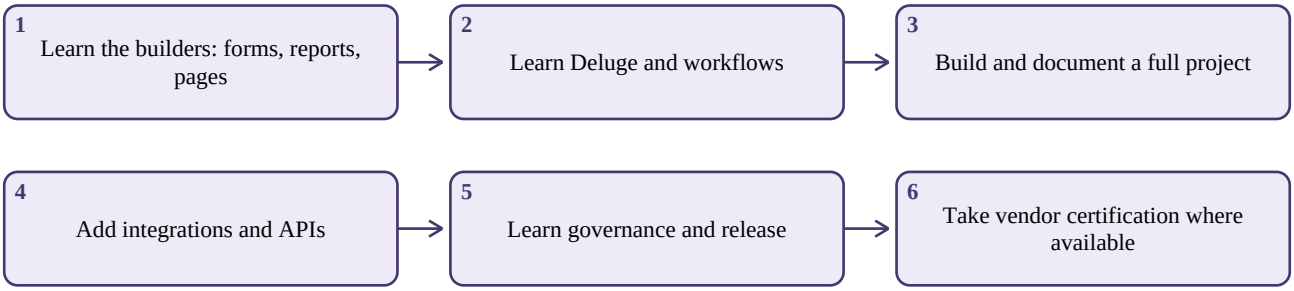


Fig 15.1 — Learning path (schematic drawn from the specification; not a screenshot)

Future of Low-Code

- **AI in the platform:** prompt-based app generation, AI models and agents will take over more of the routine building and analysis.
- **Hybrid development:** low-code for the front and workflow, pro-code services for heavy logic, as discussed in Experiments 13 and 14.
- **Governance as a first-class feature:** environments, roles and audit will be more important as more people build.
- **Wider integration:** ready connectors will reduce the effort to link applications to each other.

Published forecasts, such as the Gartner projection reported in Experiment 3, expect low-code to account for a growing share of new applications. These are forecasts, and the skills above are valuable whether or not they are met in full.

Relevance to the Loan Application

A bank is a good test of these skills: forms with validation, a controlled process with approvals, strict roles, integration with other services and a clear need for governance. Having built and documented this project, the student has worked through each stage that a professional low-code developer would meet.

Reflection (to be written in the student's own words)

Write three or four lines on which role interests you most, which experiment taught you the most, and which skill you want to strengthen next.

Question	My answer
Role of interest	
Most useful experiment	
Skill to strengthen next	

Result

Career pathways, required skills and the future of low-code were studied with reference to the Bank Loan Application project.

Conclusion

Low-code does not remove the need for design, logic and discipline; it moves the effort to modelling, integration and governance. The fifteen experiments together form a small but complete portfolio of those skills.